

Djokovic Loses in Shanghai Just Days After a Big Win

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-10-09 3 min read

Tennis star Novak Djokovic had a surprise loss at the Shanghai Masters in China. It came just three days after he won the China Open in Beijing.

Hubert Hurkacz of Poland beat Djokovic 6-4, 6-3 in 87 minutes. It was the first time Hurkacz had ever beaten him. Djokovic had won all eight of their earlier matches.

"It's a special night," Hurkacz said. He called Djokovic a **legend** and said it was a pleasure to play him.

Djokovic was tired from a busy **stretch**. This was his sixth match in 10 days. In Beijing, the 39-year-old won the 102nd title of his career. Djokovic holds the men's record of 24 **Grand Slam** titles.

Now Djokovic hopes to play in the ATP Finals, a special event for the top eight players at the end of the **season**. He is ninth in the race right now, so he needs to play well at the Paris Masters in November.

Word Treasure

Grand Slam -- One of tennis's four biggest tournaments.

legend -- A person who is famous for doing great things for a long time.

stretch -- A period of time.

season -- The part of the year when a sport's games or matches are played.

Background you need

Top tennis players travel to tournaments all over the world during the season.

At the end of the year, only the eight best men's players get to play in a special event called the ATP Finals.

Break it down

WHO: Tennis stars Novak Djokovic and Hubert Hurkacz

WHAT: Hurkacz beat Djokovic for the first time, 6-4, 6-3

WHERE: The Shanghai Masters in China

WHY: Djokovic was tired after six matches in 10 days, and Hurkacz played well

Why it matters

It shows that even the best players can lose, and that hard work can pay off for someone who keeps trying.

Test what you remember

1. Who beat Novak Djokovic?

- ☐ (A) Alex de Minaur
- ☐ (B) Carlos Alcaraz
- ☐ (C) Andy Murray
- ☐ (D) Hubert Hurkacz

2. Where was the match played?

- ☐ (A) The Shanghai Masters in China
- ☐ (B) Wimbledon in London
- ☐ (C) Paris
- ☐ (D) The US Open in New York

3. What was the score?

- ☐ (A) 6-1, 6-2
- ☐ (B) 6-4, 6-3
- ☐ (C) 7-5, 7-5
- ☐ (D) 6-0, 6-0

4. How many earlier matches had Djokovic won against Hurkacz?

- ☐ (A) Eight
- ☐ (B) Three
- ☐ (C) None
- ☐ (D) One

5. What did Djokovic win just three days earlier?

- ☐ (A) The ATP Finals
- ☐ (B) The Paris Masters
- ☐ (C) An Olympic gold medal
- ☐ (D) The China Open in Beijing

6. How many Grand Slam titles does Djokovic have?

- ☐ (A) 24
- ☐ (B) 10
- ☐ (C) 39
- ☐ (D) 102

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: A 3: B 4: A 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Hubert Hurkacz: Called it a special night and said it was a pleasure to play a legend.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):